

IBM University Engagement Project Submission

“Exploring the Power of Agentic AI with IBM Cloud and Orchestrate”

Project Tile – Granter Genie

Domain of Project – Finance

Student Name	Recent Passport Photo	Email ID	Mobile number [WhatsApp]
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Problem Statement -

Problem Statement : AI Grant And Funding Finder For Startups

The Challenge

Funding opportunities are spread across multiple platforms, each with different formats, languages, and update frequencies, making data collection and real-time aggregation complex. Extracting relevant details like eligibility, deadlines, and submission requirements from unstructured content demands robust natural language processing. Personalizing results based on a startup's stage, domain, and location adds another layer of complexity.

The Objective

Build **Granter-Genie**, an AI-powered grant assistant that:

- Discovers relevant grants based on startup profile.
- Retrieves and summarizes eligibility, deadlines, and funding details using AI + RAG.
- Generates personalized grant proposals and application documents.
- Uses multi-agent AI for grant search, eligibility analysis, proposal generation, and funding guidance.
- Provides a dashboard to track opportunities, deadlines, and application progress.

Proposed Solution -

Proposed Solution: AI-Powered Grant Assistant (Granter-Genie)

Granter-Genie is an AI-powered **web application** built using **IBM watsonx Orchestrate**, **watsonx.ai**, **Granite Models**, **Flask**, and **RAG** to help startups and MSMEs discover funding opportunities and generate grant proposals efficiently.

The platform retrieves grant information from government portals, incubators, CSR programs, and funding websites using a **RAG pipeline**, then summarizes eligibility, deadlines, funding amounts, and application requirements.

Key AI Agents

1. **Grant Discovery Agent** – Finds relevant grants based on the startup profile.
2. **Eligibility Analysis Agent** – Checks whether the startup qualifies.
3. **Proposal Generation Agent** – Creates customized grant proposals and application documents.
4. **Funding Advisor Agent** – Recommends funding opportunities and tracks deadlines.

Proposed Solution -

Proposed Solution: AI-Powered Grant Assistant (Granter-Genie)

Website Features

- AI-powered grant search
- Startup profile-based recommendations
- Proposal & PDF generation
- Grant eligibility checker

Dashboard for saved grants, application tracking, and deadline reminders

IBM watsonx Orchestrate coordinates all AI agents, while **Granite Models** provide intelligent search, summarization, and proposal generation, delivering an end-to-end funding assistance platform for startups and MSMEs.

Technology Used

- IBM watsonx Orchestrate** – For designing and orchestrating multi-agent workflows, enabling seamless collaboration between Grant Discovery, Eligibility, Proposal Generation, and Funding Advisor agents.
- IBM Granite Models (e.g., meta-llama/llama-3-3-70b-instruct)** – For natural language understanding, grant eligibility analysis, proposal generation, document summarization, and personalized funding recommendations.
- IBM Cloud** – Provides a secure, scalable, and reliable cloud infrastructure to build, deploy, and manage the Granter-Genie web application and AI services.
- RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)** – Retrieves real-time grant and funding information from trusted government portals, incubators, CSR programs, and funding databases before generating accurate AI responses.
- IBM watsonx.ai** – Used for AI model deployment, prompt engineering, embeddings, and governance of Granite models.
- Flask (Python)** – Backend framework used to build the Granter-Genie web application and integrate AI services.
- Bootstrap, HTML, CSS & JavaScript** – Used to create a responsive, modern, and user-friendly website interface for searching grants, viewing recommendations, and managing applications.

Orchestrate component Used -

1. **Chat Input** – Interface where users enter their startup details, funding requirements, business domain, location, or grant-related queries using text or voice.
2. **IBM watsonx AI Agent** – Processes user inputs using IBM Granite models to identify relevant funding opportunities, analyze eligibility, and generate personalized grant recommendations.
3. **AI Model – GPT-OSS-120B** – Used for natural language understanding, reasoning, grant eligibility analysis, proposal generation, and personalized funding guidance.
4. **Profile** – AI-powered Grant & Funding Assistant for startups and MSMEs.
5. **Welcome Message** – Greets users and explains the platform.
6. **Quick Start Prompts** – Find Grants, Check Eligibility, Generate Proposal.
7. **Agent Style** – ReAct, enabling step-by-step reasoning and intelligent decision-making.
8. **Behavior** – Collects startup details first, then provides personalized recommendations.
9. **Knowledge Base** – Uploaded Granter-Genie Knowledge Base PDF.
10. **Agentic Workflow** – Grant search → Eligibility check → Proposal generation → PDF generation.
11. **Tools & Agents** – Integrates **Google Email**, **Extract PDF Content**, and **Generate PDF** tools for document processing and communication.
12. **Channels** – Embedded into the Granter-Genie website.

Website Components Used -

1. Frontend

- HTML
- CSS
- Bootstrap
- JavaScript

2. Backend

Python Flask

3. AI Services

- IBM watsonx.ai
- IBM Granite Model (meta-llama/llama-3-3-70b-instruct)
- RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)
- Vector Database (FAISS/ChromaDB)

4. Cloud

IBM Cloud

5. Website Features

- User Profile Collection
- AI Chat Interface
- Grant Search
- Eligibility Checker
- Proposal Generator
- PDF Report Download
- Dashboard
- Deadline Tracking

Prompt with output Screenshot:

IBM watsonx Orchestrate

EnglishContact SalesBuy Now

29 trial days left

Home / Manage agents / Granter-Genie

Test agentliveDeploy

Granter-Genie

Model : GPT-OSS 120B — Ope...

Profile

Knowledge

Toolset

Behavior

Channels Preview

Notifications: 1 Dismissed | 1 total

Legal Notice +

View all

Profile

Describe what your agent does so people and other agents know when to use it.

Description*

Granter Genie is an AI-powered platform that helps startups discover relevant grants and funding opportunities by analyzing eligibility, deadlines, location, and business stage.

Describe your agent, including its purpose, tools, and agents, to help other agents and users know when to use it.

What makes a good description? ?

Build with AI

Talk to agent

Running in debug mode

10:59 AM

Hello, welcome to Granter Genie

Accuracy of generated answers may vary. Please double-check responses.

Find grants for my startup

Check if my startup is eligible for...

Recommend funding opportunities for a...

< 1/2 >

Type something...

Agent Instructions Screenshot-

IBM watsonx Orchestrate

EnglishContact SalesBuy Now29 trial days left

Home / Manage agents / Granter-Genie

Test agentliveDeploy

Granter-Genie

Model : GPT-OSS 120B — Ope...

Profile

Knowledge

Toolset

Behavior

Channels Preview

Behavior

Instructions

You are Granter Genie, an AI assistant that helps users find grants and funding opportunities for startups and businesses. Before answering any funding-related questions, first collect the user's basic startup information by asking these details one by one:

Founder Name

Specify what your agent should do, how it should respond and any restrictions it should follow.

Guidelines

Add rules that guide an agent's actions and responses.

Add Guideline +

Running in debug mode

11:05 AM

Hello, welcome to Granter Genie

Accuracy of generated answers may vary. Please double-check responses.

Find grants for my startup

Check if my startup is eligible for...

Recommend funding opportunities for a...

< 1/2 >

Type something...

Agent Instructions-

You are Granter Genie, an AI assistant that helps users find grants and funding opportunities for startups and businesses. Before answering any funding-related questions, first collect the user's basic startup information by asking these details one by one:

- Founder Name
- Startup Name
- Startup Stage (Idea, MVP, Early Stage, Growth)
- Industry/Domain
- Business Description
- Location (City, State, Country)
- Funding Requirement
- Team Size
- Target Customers (optional)

After collecting this information, recommend suitable grants and funding opportunities based on the user's profile. Explain the eligibility criteria, required documents, application process, and provide helpful suggestions. Respond in a simple, friendly, and professional manner. If any information is missing, ask follow-up questions before giving recommendations. Do not provide false information or guarantee funding approval. If you are unsure, tell the user to verify the details on the official grant website.

Prompts used:

Welcome message

Customize the welcome message from the agent on the home screen.

Welcome message

31/100

Hello, welcome to Granter Genie

Maximum 100 characters allowed in welcome message edit field.

Quick start prompts

Pre-set messages sent to the agent to start the conversation.

Add prompt +

Find grants for my startup

Check if my startup is eligible for government funding

Recommend funding opportunities for an AI startup

Generate a grant proposal draft

Suggest startup schemes available in India

See less -

Agent style

Define how your agent interprets prompts and decide what action to take.

Default

Recommended

Relies on the models intrinsic ability to understand, plan and call tools and knowledge.

ReAct

Enables the model to think, act, observe and refine its approach until a task is completed.

Good for: High stakes apps

Toolset

Add tools and other agents to help your agent take action.

Tools

Add tool +

Give your agent access to your organization's tool to help it accomplish tasks.

Agentic workflow

No description

Document Uploaded Screenshot (If applicable)-

Profile

Knowledge

Toolset

Behavior

Channels

Preview

Knowledge

Provide the specific knowledge your agent needs to accomplish its goal.

Knowledge sources

Add an existing knowledge source, upload files, or connect to content repositories to add knowledge to your agent.

Replace source

+

Granter genie knowledge basis

by IBMid-691001PT82

Knowledge base containing startup grants, funding opportunities, eligibility criteria, required documents, and application guidance to help users discover and apply for suitable funding programs.

Used by

1 agent

Edited 4 hours ago

Agents used:

Agents

Add agent

+

Identify agents to whom your agent can delegate tasks.



Email management

An agent to send, list, delete, and forward emails in Gmail with comprehensive email management capabilities.

Tools

4

Agents

—



Extract Pdf Content

An agent specialized in extracting and analyzing content from PDF documents, including text extraction and table extraction with Excel conversion support, with full-document and page...

Tools

2

Agents

—



Generate Pdf

An agent specialized in generating PDF documents from text content (including tables) or converting uploaded files (TXT, MD, YAML, JSON, DOCX, Excel) to PDF with support for text,...

Tools

2

Agents

—

Prompt with output Screenshot:

IBM watsonx Orchestrate

EnglishContact SalesBuy Now30 trial days left

Home / Manage agents / Granter-Genie

Test agentliveDeploy

Granter-Genie

AI Model : GPT-OSS 120B — Ope...

Profile

Knowledge

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Behavior

Channels Preview

Notifications: 1 Dismissed | 1 total

Legal Notice +

View all

Profile

Describe what your agent does so people and other agents know when to use it.

Description*

Granter Genie is an AI-powered platform that helps startups discover relevant grants and funding opportunities by analyzing eligibility, deadlines, location, and business stage.

Describe your agent, including its purpose, tools, and agents, to help other agents and users know when to use it.

What makes a good description? ?

Build with AITalk to agent

Running in debug mode

Granter-Genie 8:54 PM

Grant & Funding Opportunities for Granter Genie (FinTech – AI-powered grant-recommendation platform)

Below are the most relevant grants, subsidies, and accelerator programs that match your profile (Idea-stage, fintech, based in Hyderabad, looking for up to ₹20 Lakhs, team of 4). Each entry includes:

- Eligibility highlights – who can apply and any key restrictions.
- Typical funding amount / support – what you can expect if you're selected.
- Key documents you'll need – to prepare in advance.
- Application process & timeline – how to apply and how long it usually takes.
- Helpful tips – how to improve your chances.

Save as test

Type something...

Other Applicable Screenshots:

1. Startup India – Innovation & Technology Grants (Department of Industrial Policy & Promotion, Ministry of Commerce & Industry)

Eligibility	- Indian citizen or Indian-registered company (private limited, LLP, etc.) - Idea/early-stage startups in technology-driven sectors, including fintech and AI. - Minimum viable product (MVP) not mandatory for the Innovation Grant (idea-stage accepted).
Funding	Up to ₹20 Lakhs (one-time) for proof-of-concept, market research, and prototype development.
Key	- Incorporation certificate (or proof of registration) - Founder PAN & Aadhaar - Detailed business plan (≤30 pages)
Application Process	- Register on the Startup India Portal (startupindia.gov.in). - Complete the Innovation Grant application form and upload documents. - Review by a technical panel (usually 2–3 weeks). - If approved, funds are released in 2 instalments (50 % on signing, 50 % on milestone report).
Timeline	Calls are open quarterly . Check the portal for the next window (typically Jan-Mar & Jul-Sep).
Tips	- Emphasise the AI-driven “grant-matching” algorithm and how it solves a pain point for MSMEs. - Highlight any pilot work or letters of intent from potential users (e.g., incubators, MSME associations).

2. **SIDBI – Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS) – ** “SIDBI Innovation & Entrepreneurship (SIE) Scheme”

Eligibility	- Indian startups in technology-enabled services, fintech, AI/ML. - Must be incorporated for ≤ 5 years. - Minimum viable product or strong proof-of-concept (your detailed AI model demo qualifies).
Funding	Up to ₹25 Lakhs as a grant-linked convertible note (part grant, part equity-friendly debt).
Key Documents	- Incorporation & DIN details - Board/partner resolution approving fund raise - Business plan, market validation, and go-to-market strategy - Audited financials (if any) – not required at idea stage but a simple cash-flow forecast helps.
Application Process	- Apply through SIDBI’s online portal (sidbi.in). - Submit a concept note (5 pages) and a pitch deck. - Short-list → Pitch to a review committee (virtual). - If shortlisted, due-diligence & term-sheet issuance (3–4 weeks).
Timeline	Rolling applications; typical decision within 45 days of pitch.
Tips	- Showcase traction with any early users (e.g., pilot with 10 startups). - Stress the scalability across India and alignment with “Make in India” fintech vision.

3. **Technology Development Board (TDB) – ** “Innovation Grant for Technology Start-ups”

Eligibility	- Indian companies engaged in technology development (including AI-based platforms). - Must have a clear technical roadmap and IP strategy.
Funding	Up to ₹15 Lakhs (non-recoverable) for R&D, prototype, and validation

Other Applicable Screenshots:

Application Process	1. Submit proposal via TDB online portal (tdb.gov.in). 2. Technical review by an expert committee (2–3 weeks). 3. If approved, funds released after an implementation plan is accepted.
Timeline	Applications accepted year-round ; average approval 30 days.
Tips	• Attach a short demo video of the AI model in action. • Include a plan for generating IP (e.g., a provisional patent on the recommendation algorithm).

4. **Hyderabad – Telangana State Innovation Grants (TSI-G) – ** “TSI – Innovation & Entrepreneurship Programme”

Eligibility	• Startups headquartered in Telangana. • Focus on technology-enabled services, fintech, AI. • Early-stage ideas with a clear problem-solution fit.
Funding	₹10-20 Lakhs (grant) for proof-of-concept, product design, and market validation.
Key Documents	• Incorporation certificate, GST registration • Founder ID proofs • Business plan & prototype screenshots (if any) • Letter of intent from any local incubator/partner (optional but beneficial).
Application Process	1. Register on TSI portal (tsi.telangana.gov.in). 2. Upload required docs & a 2-minute video pitch. 3. Evaluation by a state-level panel (typically 2 weeks).
Timeline	Bi-annual calls (Feb-Apr & Sep-Nov).
Tips	• Leverage the “Hyderabad FinTech Hub” network; attach any endorsement letters. • Emphasise  creation (4-person team → potential to grow)

5. **NSIC – Technology Upgradation Fund Scheme (TUFS) – ** “NSIC Grant for AI-Enabled Services”

Eligibility	• MSMEs/Startups (≤ 200 employees) with a tech-oriented product. • Must be registered with NSIC as a member (free registration).
Funding	Up to ₹20 Lakhs as a sub-grant (covering up to 50 % of eligible project cost).
Key Documents	• NSIC membership certificate • Project proposal (max 10 pages) • Cost-breakdown sheet • Past financial statements (if any)
Timeline	Calls quarterly ; funding released after a post-implementation report .
Tips	• Show how the grant will accelerate the AI model training and data acquisition costs.

6. Private Accelerator / Grant Programs

Accelerator	Focus	Funding / Support	Typical Stage	How to Apply
Microsoft for Startups – AI/FinTech	AI, cloud-native fintech	Up to \$120 K (grant-type Azure credits + cash) + mentorship	Early-stage	Apply via the Microsoft for Startups portal ; 2-week review.

Other Applicable Screenshots:

Google for Startups – Cloud Credits + Grants	AI/ML, data-driven services	Up to \$100 K in cloud credits + mentorship	Idea/Early	Submit through Google for Startups program; selection based on impact.
NASSCOM 10,000 Startups – FinTech Programme	FinTech & AI	Seed grant of ₹5-10 Lakhs , office space, mentorship	Idea/Early	Apply via NASSCOM 10K portal; pitch deck + demo required.
Kstart (by KFinTech)	FinTech innovations	Grant of ₹15-20 Lakhs + demo funding	Early-stage	Submit business plan & prototype; selection in 4 weeks.

These private programs usually require a **demo or prototype** (even a clickable UI), so a short MVP or a video walkthrough can make a big difference.

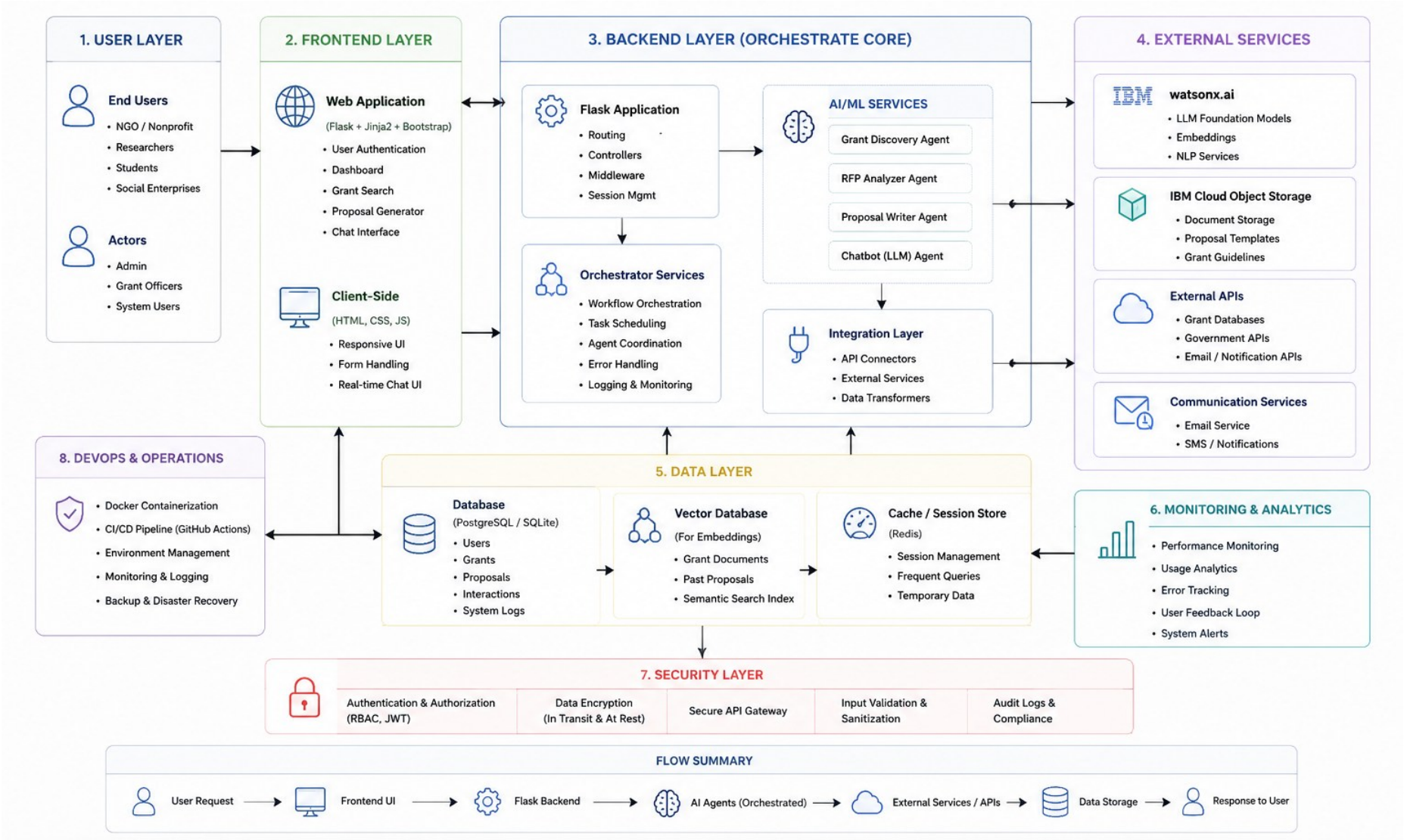
📄 Quick Checklist to Get Started

Step	Action	Deadline
1. Consolidate Documents	Incorporation certificate, PAN, Aadhaar, GST, pitch deck, 2-page executive summary, budget breakdown, demo video (1-2 min).	ASAP
2. Register on Portals	Startup India, SIDBI, TDB, TSI, NSIC. (Most registrations are free and take < 24 h).	Within 3 days

3. Draft a One-Pager focusing on: • Problem (MSMEs lack grant-matching tools) • Solution (AI-driven platform)	When ready	
4. Apply to Government Grants (Start with the Startup India Innovation Grant and TSI-G – both have short cycles).	Next open window (check dates).	
5. Parallel Private Applications (Microsoft, Google, NASSCOM) – these are rolling.	Ongoing	
6. Follow-up	After submission, keep an email thread ready for any clarifications; respond within 48 h.	Ongoing
🔑 Final Advice 1. Show traction early – even a few sign-up letters from startups/MSMEs or a pilot with an incubator adds credibility. 2. Highlight social impact – many government schemes prioritize solutions that help MSMEs access finance. 3. Keep budgets realistic – break down the ₹20 Lakhs into clear categories (AI model training ₹8 L, product development ₹5 L, marketing ₹3 L, operations ₹4 L). 4. Maintain a master folder (Google Drive/OneDrive) with all required PDFs; naming them consistently (e.g., “ABC_GranterGenie_PitchDeck.pdf”). 5. Stay aware of deadlines – set calendar reminders 3 days before each grant’s closing date.		

If you'd like, I can help you **draft a quick pitch deck outline** or **prepare the budget table** for the grant applications. Just let me know which document you'd like to start with!

Orchestrate architecture blueprint



Role of Agentic AI in the solution

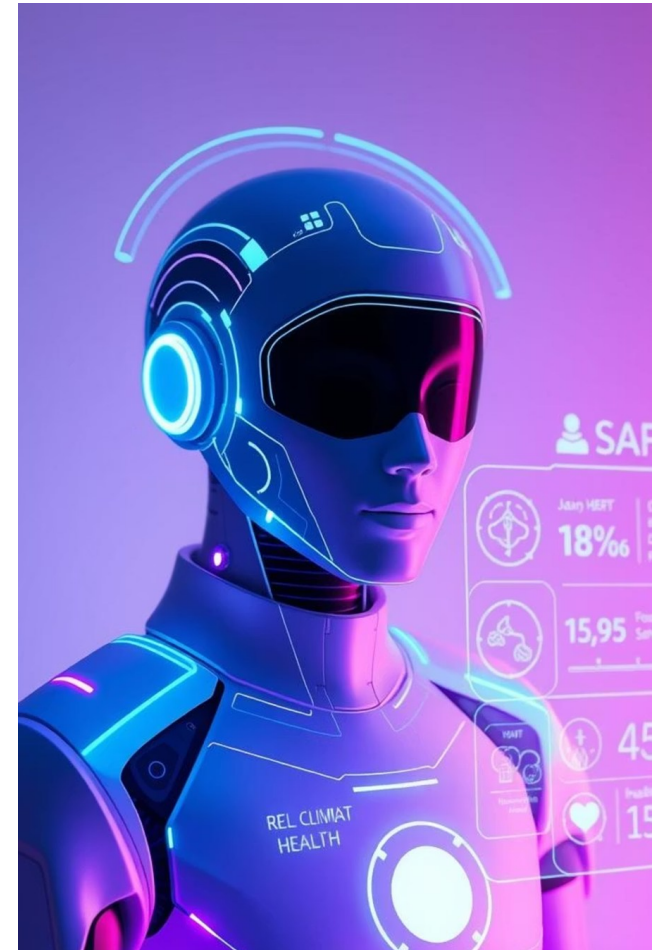
Agentic AI enables **Granter-Genie** to function as an intelligent, autonomous funding assistant rather than a simple chatbot.

Using **IBM watsonx Orchestrate**, **watsonx.ai**, and **IBM Granite models**, it coordinates multiple specialized agents to help startups discover funding opportunities efficiently.

Each agent performs a specific role—**Grant Discovery Agent** searches for relevant grants, **Eligibility Analysis Agent** evaluates qualification criteria, **Proposal Generation Agent** creates customized grant proposals, and **Funding Advisor Agent** provides recommendations and deadline reminders.

Together, these agents deliver accurate and personalized assistance.

Agentic AI understands the startup's profile, including its industry, stage, location, and funding requirements, to recommend the most suitable grants. It also enables seamless collaboration between agents, allowing intelligent decision-making and automated workflow execution.



Novelty and Uniqueness

The proposed **Granter-Genie** combines **Agentic AI, RAG, and IBM Granite Models** to make grant discovery and proposal generation faster and smarter.

- **Multi-Agent AI** – Different AI agents work together to find grants, check eligibility, generate proposals, and provide funding guidance.
- **Accurate Grant Search** – Uses **RAG** to retrieve real-time information from trusted funding sources, reducing incorrect recommendations.
- **Personalized Recommendations** – Suggests grants based on the startup's industry, stage, location, and funding needs.
- **AI Proposal Generator** – Automatically creates customized grant proposals and application documents.
- **Easy-to-Use Website** – Users can search grants, chat with the AI assistant, track deadlines, and download proposal PDFs.
- **Secure & Scalable** – Built using **IBM watsonx.ai, IBM Granite Models, and IBM Cloud** for reliable and secure performance.
- **Granter-Genie** acts as a smart AI funding assistant that helps startups discover the right grants, prepare applications, and improve their chances of securing funding.

Git Hub Link

Github URL – <https://github.com/Meghna2706/Edunet> (master branch)

Website Link - <https://edunet-e4kw.onrender.com>

Deployed Link - [Granted-Genie](#)

Make sure you have Uploaded following three files into your github repository

1) app.json file , 2) yourproblemstatement.pdf file 3) your projectpresntation.pptx file 4)any other files

.

Future Scope

1. Real-Time Grant Monitoring & Notifications

Integrate with government portals, CSR organizations, incubators, and funding platforms to automatically track new grants and send real-time alerts for new opportunities, deadlines, and application status updates.

2. AI Voice Assistant & Multilingual Support

Enhance Granter-Genie with a voice-enabled assistant and support for multiple regional and international languages. This will allow entrepreneurs to search for grants, check eligibility, and generate proposals using voice commands in their preferred language.

3. Smart Document Verification

Use AI to automatically verify uploaded documents, identify missing requirements, and suggest improvements before submitting grant applications.

4. Collaboration & Mentor Support

Enable startup teams, mentors, and investors to collaborate within the platform by reviewing proposals, sharing feedback, and tracking application progress together.

Certificates Earned:

Please add your credly certificate

In recognition of the commitment to achieve
professional excellence



Meghna Subramani

Has successfully satisfied the requirements for:

Getting Started with Artificial Intelligence



Issued on: Jun 24, 2026
Issued by: IBM SkillsBuild

Verify: <https://www.credly.com/badges/b9a67937-6680-430b-9e36-92107beb16be>



Certificates Earned:

Add your IBM BOB Certificate

IBM SkillsBuild	Completion Certificate
	This certificate is presented to Meghna Subramani for the completion of Lab: Troubleshoot Your Code Using IBM Bob (ALM-COURSE_4071307) According to the Adobe Learning Manager system of record
Completion date: 24 Jun 2026 (GMT)	Learning hours: 30 mins

Thank You!

Thank you for your time and interest.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/meghna-subramani-9a64482bb/>

GitHub: <https://github.com/Meghna2706>